Bench-supported one-arm row

Pull / back / 8-12 each side



START / softly extended arm

FINISH / controlled pull

MAIN: Latissimus dorsi: draws the upper arm back toward the trunk.

SECONDARY: Rhomboids and middle trapezius control the shoulder blade; rear deltoid and elbow flexors assist the pull.

BASE / SUPPORT: Abdominals and spinal stabilizers resist rotation. Hips, thighs and ankle muscles steady both feet; the other arm supports the torso.

01 / Check the setup

Use a stable bench and a secure front rack anchor near the working hand’s starting height. Clip one handle to one continuous pull line; keep the recoil path clear.

02 / Set the base and brace

Plant both feet in a comfortable stagger. Support the opposite palm under its shoulder. Incline from the hips; keep neck and trunk aligned, knees soft.

03 / Move with control

Gently brace while breathing. Exhale and guide the working elbow toward the lower ribs; keep the shoulder away from the ear.

04 / Limit the range and return

Stop before the torso twists, the shoulder rolls forward or the elbow has to travel far behind the body. Return slowly to a softly extended arm.

WATCH FOR: Both feet and the support hand stay planted. Shorten the pull or reduce resistance if you shrug, jerk or rotate. EASIER: Rehearse unloaded, use less tension, or use a more upright supported row if the hinge is uncomfortable.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: ACE - Single-arm Row; ACE - Back exercise research; ACE - Resistance-band workout builder. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html